IMPERIAL

Sustainable Business

Lecture 2 – Course Assessment

Dr James Robey
18/02/2026

Course Assessment:

ASSESSMENT

Your grade for the course will be made up as follows:

Examination – individual 70%
Format long / short answer
Exam prep in last lectures

Group Assignment 30%

Your Assignment

You are part of a team of consultants working for a sustainability advisory firm. Your client has brought you in to review their sustainability strategy. Using only publicly available information about the company's sustainability strategy and carbon accounts, you should:

1. Briefly introduce your company and summarise their existing sustainability situation in the context of their business strategy. Summarise the company's sustainability strategy including their targets and progress against targets.

2. Identify 3 or 4 relevant competitors / similar organisations and carry out a quantitative and qualitative benchmark. We suggest that you:

   - Choose competitors where you can find easily (publicly) available and quantitative information, for example companies with clear integrated or sustainability reports and companies that respond to the CDP
   - Focus your benchmark on comparing your client's current sustainability strategy, commitments and performance against the chosen competitors and highlight key differences and best practices.

   Use the benchmark to specifically critique your chosen company's sustainability programme highlighting strengths and weaknesses.

3. Based on this analysis, set out your recommended social and environmental sustainability strategies through to 2035. Clearly articulate your recommended targets (environmental and social) and the key initiatives required to deliver the targets.

   - Think about the implications for both the operations of the business and also the goods / services that it produces.
   - The strategy should be realistic and achievable - make sure it is economically / financially logical (but note, this is not a financial planning exercise).

4. Include a two-minute executive summary video setting out your recommended strategy for the organisation.

5. Finally, you will need to produce a separate document explaining how you employed AI in researching and preparing your assignment.

Your Assignment

You have been requested to present the Sustainability Strategy as a standalone web site (e.g. wix.com, or of your own design).

Consider that the web site should be designed such that the future strategy sections could be embedded in the company's existing web site.

- The web site should be designed to be reviewed and appraised by the company's Board of Directors - office / at home / in an airline executive lounge
- The site should focus on the key material issues for the company
- Content therefore should be readable / digestible in a 30 minute timeframe
- The site should also contain a 2-minute video executive summary of the sustainability strategy

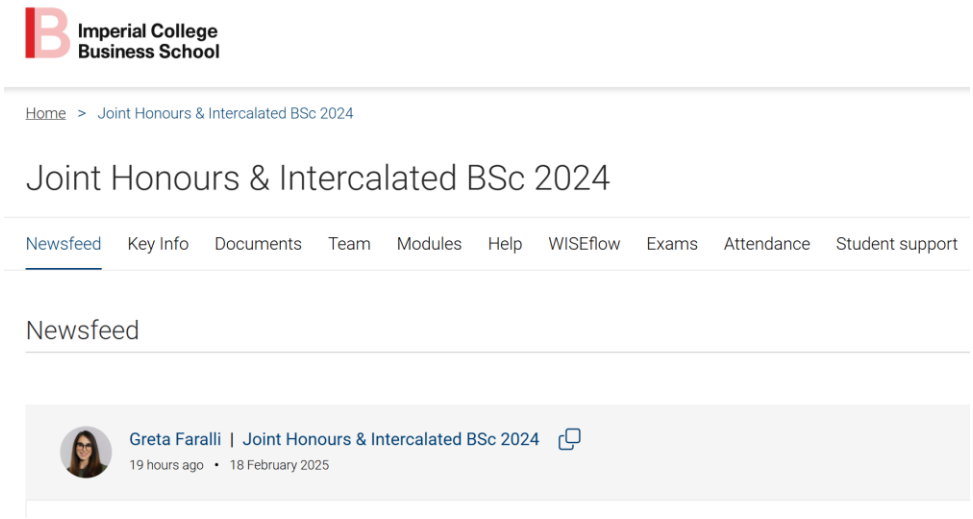
- **The site must have a password**

- **Please do not approach the company**

Choice of Company

A list of potential companies will be added to the portal tomorrow. You may select any company from the list providing that it hasn't already been selected.

- To select a company, reply to the post clearly indicating your group number and choice of company.
- It is first come, first served – once a company has been chosen (as indicated in the replies), you need to pick another company
- Please email me confirmation of your choice at j.robey@imperial.ac.uk
- Please select your company no later than **12:00 Wednesday 25th February**



Use of AI

- **If you used AI <u>in any way</u> in the preparation of your project**, you must meet the following two requirements:

  1. Provide a **separate document** clearly explaining (in 1,000 – 2,000 words) how you used AI in this assignment, including details of the AI tools employed and a few examples of key prompts employed. Also, specifically explain the steps you undertook to ensure the AI assimilated information is accurate and correct. Finally, reflect on what was most and least useful in the content developed by AI.

  2. **You must include a statement on its own webpage**, with a link from your home page, to acknowledge your use of AI tools within the project. This statement should be written in complete sentences and include the following information:

  - Name(s) and version(s) of the GenAI tool used (e.g. ChatGPT-3.5)
  - Publisher (the company that provides the GenAI system; e.g. OpenAI)
  - URL of the AI tool (if applicable)
  - Brief description (single sentence) of the way in which the GenAI tool was used
  - Confirmation that the work is your own

  - For example: ”We acknowledge the use of ChatGPT-3.5 (OpenAI, https://chat.openai.comLinks to an external site) to generate an outline for background study. We confirm that no output generated by GenAI has been presented as our own work.”

- Note: **<u>if you have not used AI tools</u> to help with your project,** you must still include a statement in your website to acknowledge this fact. For example: “We declare that no AI tools have been used in any way to research, develop or produce this assignment.”

Assignment Deadline:

Submit your web url (and password) to the Hub by:

16.00 on Monday 23rd March 2026

Please email a copy to: j.robey@imperial.ac.uk

Some example websites from previous years:

- https://aa16017.wixsite.com/mondelez (Password: oreo)
- https://ibscgroup1.wixsite.com/website (Password: ibsc1)
- https://hi5160.wixsite.com/gskibsc08 (Password: ibsc08)
- https://jff192.wixsite.com/website (Password: Sanofi2020)

Note: Do not copy the format – the assignment questions were slightly different in different years.

Companies

- Accenture
- Anglo American
- Apple
- AstraZeneca
- BAE Systems
- BASF
- Bayer
- British Airways
- Carrefour
- Danone
- GSK
- H&M
- Heathrow
- Heineken
- IBM
- Kingfisher
- L'Oreal
- Maersk
- Marks & Spencer
- Marriott International
- Nestle
- Pfizer
- Philip Morris International
- Rolls Royce (i.e. https://www.rolls-royce.com/)
- Salesforce
- Schneider Electric
- Stellantis
- Tesco
- Vodafone
- Volkswagen

Marking Criteria

You are part of a team of consultants working for a sustainability advisory firm. Your client has brought you in to review their sustainability strategy. Using only publicly available information about the company's sustainability strategy and carbon accounts, you should:

1. Briefly introduce your company and summarise their existing sustainability situation in the context of their business strategy. Summarise the company's sustainability strategy including their targets and progress against targets. } 10%

2. Identify 3 or 4 relevant competitors / similar organisations and carry out a quantitative and qualitative benchmark. We suggest that you:

   - Choose competitors where you can find easily (publicly) available and quantitative information, for example companies with clear integrated or sustainability reports and companies that respond to the CDP

   - Focus your benchmark on comparing your client's current sustainability strategy, commitments and performance against the chosen competitors and highlight key differences and best practices. } 20%

   Use the benchmark to specifically critique your chosen company's sustainability programme highlighting strengths and weaknesses. } 20%

3. Based on this analysis, set out your recommended social and environmental sustainability strategies through to 2035. Clearly articulate your recommended targets (environmental and social) and the key initiatives required to deliver the targets. } 30%

   - Think about the implications for both the operations of the business and also the goods / services that it produces.

   - The strategy should be realistic and achievable - make sure it is economically / financially logical (but note, this is not a financial planning exercise).

4. Finally, include a two-minute executive summary video setting out your recommended strategy for the organisation. } 10%

5. Overall quality of assignment presentation (including reflections on AI use) } 10%